Arabia. Despite not knowing anyone there, I met a Saudi national in Al-Khobar who proposed to work together. Armed with the capital of $25,000 of my savings, I started my first company in Saudi Arabia, partnering with NSH and employing 150 workers from Nagarcoil, Tamilnadu. From this small number we have made a phenomenal growth of having more than 150,000 employees, mostly from different states in India. We are the largest employer of Indian workforce in the Middle East.

Our breakthrough opportunity came from a French company that entrusted us to construct Defence Projects in Dhahran. Subsequently, we secured another significant project from Bechtel to build the Royal Airport Terminal in Riyadh. These initial endeavors laid the foundation for our growth as we gradually transitioned from subcontracting to undertaking petrochemical projects, followed by infrastructure projects in the 1980's.

Today, NSH, part of the RP group of companies that I formed, stands as one of the largest Industrial construction contractors in the Middle East. Our client portfolio includes esteemed global organizations such as Aramco, ADNOC, Qatar Petroleum, Exxon Mobile, Samsung Engineering,Chiyoda, Daelim, Qatar Gas, Ras Gas, and more. Over time, we have expanded our business to countries like Qatar, Bahrain, the entire UAE, various Asian nations, Australia, and Africa.

In fact, we were invited by the Australian government to establish operations in their LNG and mining sectors. We now have a technical institute in Australia that focuses on training skilled manpower for our extensive projects in the country. Over a period, we have expanded into multiple sectors like hospitality, healthcare, education, IT, and retail.



Dr. B Ravi Pillai with United States former President Mr. Barack Obama

In 1978, when the Newsprint factory faced a labor strike due to local contractors, I made a life-changing decision to move to Al Khobar, Saudi Arabia. Despite not knowing anyone there, I met a Saudi national in Al-Khobar who proposed to work together. Armed with the capital of $25,000 of my savings, I started my first company in Saudi Arabia

The journey has been challenging yet rewarding, and I am grateful for the opportunities and partnerships that have propelled the growth of our business across different regions and sectors.

Q After establishing as mega project builders, recently you have entered in to a real estate with primary focus in Dubai, what made you venture in to a risky segment.

Yes, we have made significant strides in the Dubai property market as a developer through our subsidiary, RP Global. Over the years, RP Global has successfully completed landmark projects that have garnered attention and recognition. One notable example is the 50-storied RP Heights in Business Bay, which stands as a testament to our capabilities. This residential tower encompasses service apartments, and retail outlets, adding value to the vibrant landscape of Dubai.

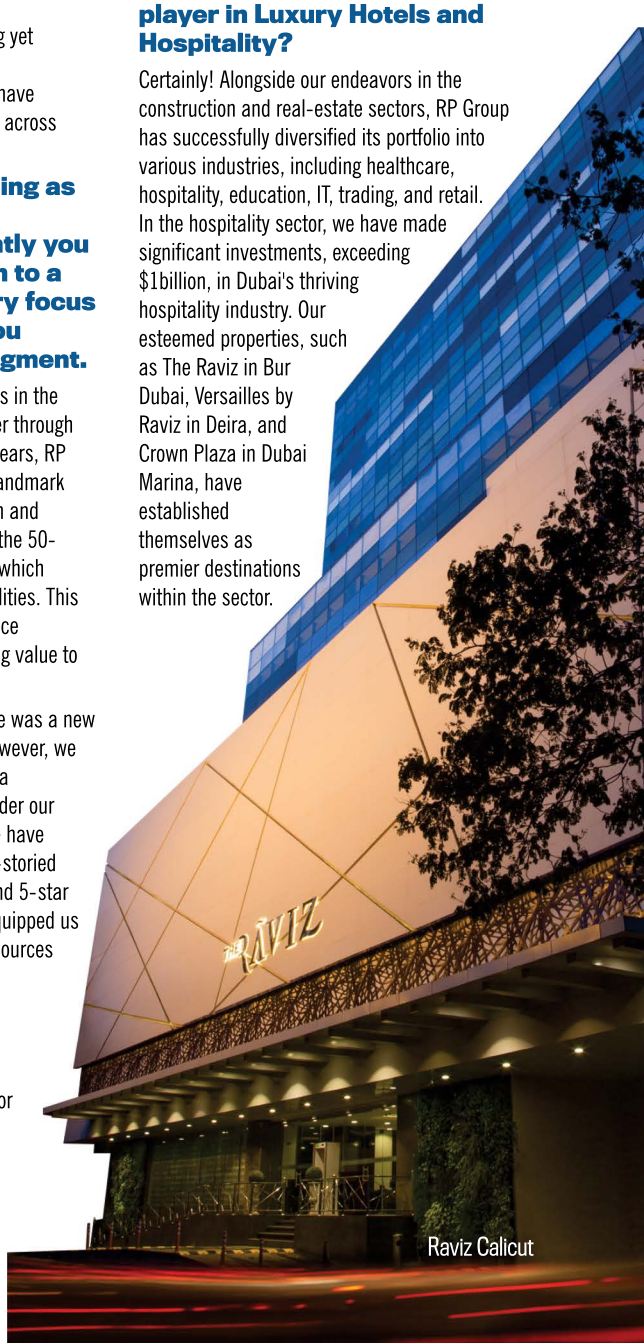
Initially, venturing into real estate was a new and risky endeavor for RP Group. However, we have adapted and grown to become a recognized player in the industry. Under our subsidiary, Gulf Asia Contracting, we have successfully delivered several multi-storied residential, commercial buildings, and 5-star luxury hotels. This experience has equipped us with the necessary expertise and resources to undertake high-quality real estate projects in Dubai.

Undoubtedly, the real estate business carries its inherent risks. However, in Dubai, the property sector continues to thrive and expand. The population of Dubai has already surpassed 3 million and is still growing, leading to an increased demand for properties. Additionally, the government of Dubai maintains excellent control and regulation over the sector. Considering these factors, Dubai currently stands as one of the most promising and lucrative real estate markets for investment.

Besides, we are not positioning ourselves as a mass developer quickly launching multiple projects for rapid growth. We are a niche developer putting focus on a particular project at a time and bringing landmark projects with high quality specifications and workmanship.

Q Beyond construction and Real-estate, where in India you are perceived as a major player in Luxury Hotels and Hospitality?

Certainly! Alongside our endeavors in the construction and real-estate sectors, RP Group has successfully diversified its portfolio into various industries, including healthcare, hospitality, education, IT, trading, and retail. In the hospitality sector, we have made significant investments, exceeding $1billion, in Dubai's thriving hospitality industry. Our esteemed properties, such as The Raviz in Bur Dubai, Versailles by Raviz in Deira, and Crown Plaza in Dubai Marina, have established themselves as premier destinations within the sector.



Raviz Calicut